

Pre-Award Phase: Panel Members

Facilitator



Amity Wilczek
*USDOT Volpe
Transportation
Center*

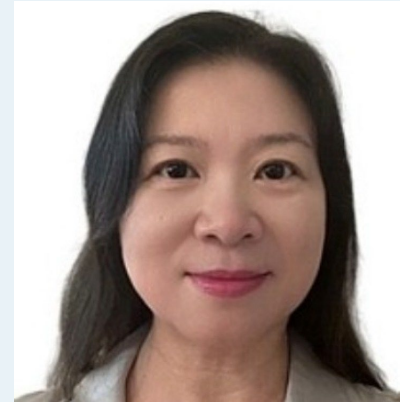
Agency Panelists



Steven Younkin
*City of Greeley, CO
Chief Engineer*



Aaron Cushman
*Nashville DOT
IT/ITS Division Manager*



Jinghua Xu
*Southern California
Association of
Governments (SCAG)
Department Manager
of Modeling*



Rose Vath
*Vermont Agency
of Transportation
AI & Business
Intelligence
Manager*

Greeley AI Procurement Requirements

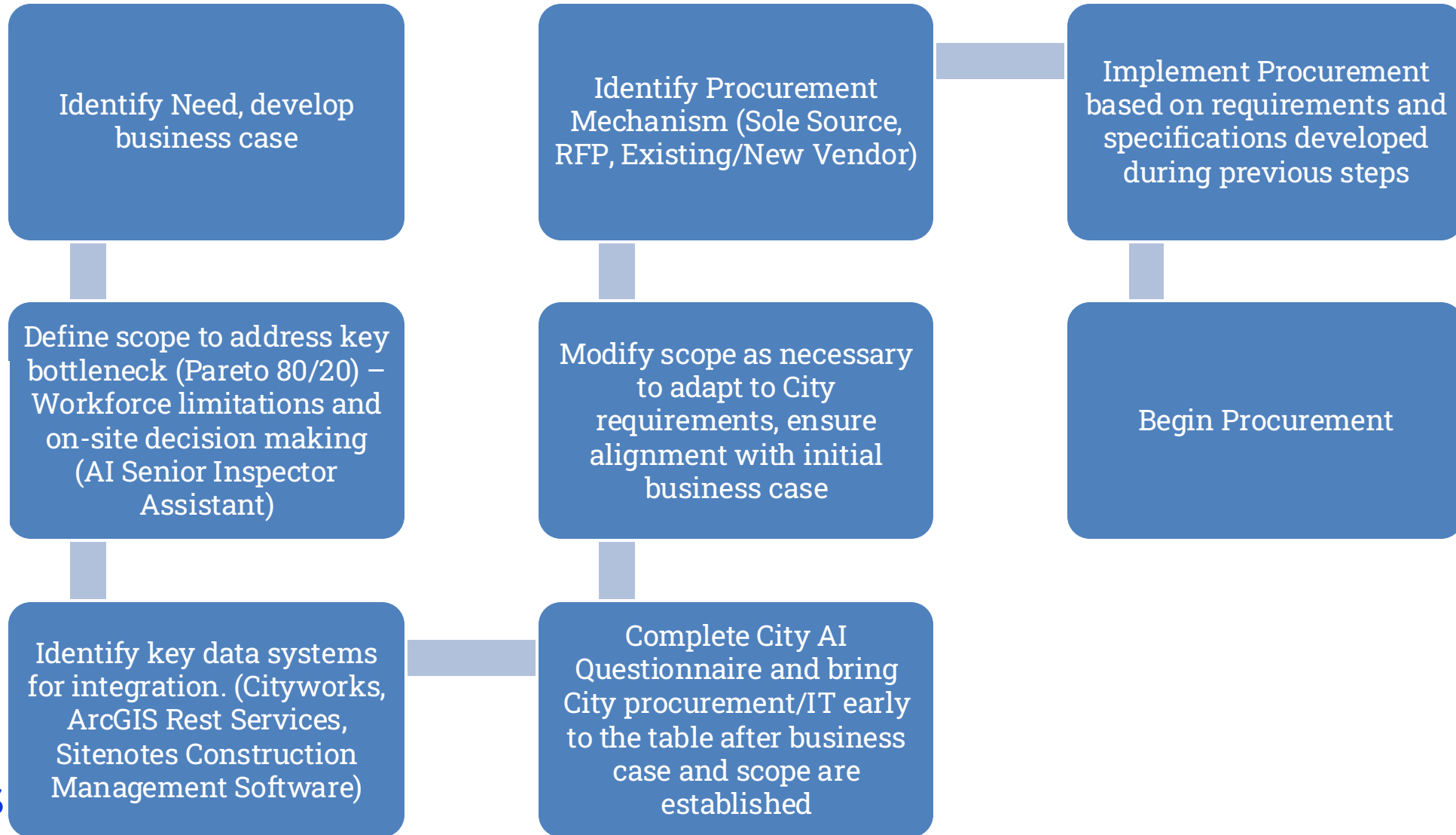
- Greeley, Pop: 116k, located 1hr north of Denver, Colorado.
- Famous for UNC campus, Stampede Rodeo, and Cattle
- City has AI System Requirements Document
 - Defines compliance with City requirements around:
 - Data Ownership
 - Algorithmic Bias
 - Explainability
 - Restricting Use
 - Performance Monitoring
 - Auditability
 - Data Protection



Greeley's Approach to Analyzing Need

- Filters for selecting AI products for City:
 - Physical AI remains immature, so Civil Design and Engineering is not yet ready
 - Staff retain ultimate responsibility for decisions. Risky decisions impacting schedule, scope, and budget of project are excluded from AI assistance.
- Address actual bottlenecks instead of “efficiency” for its own sake.
- Integration is Key
- Focus on use case playing to the strengths of AI:
 - Summarizing, Researching, Quick Answers and Prompts
- Define Business Case and what success looks like
- Conclusion: First highest need is workforce training and construction prompts

Example Case: Construction Management Software



source: adobe



SCAG's Experience - AI Procurement and Adoption

Enterprise Foundation • Responsible Governance •
Targeted Innovation

September 17, 2026

WWW.SCAG.CA.GOV

Enterprise AI Foundation

- Enterprise-First AI Strategy

Enterprise platform

Microsoft 365 Copilot is SCAG's enterprise AI platform for broad, agency-wide productivity needs.

Leverage existing agreements

Use existing Microsoft licensing, security, compliance, and governance frameworks before pursuing a separate AI product.

Reduce procurement friction

Avoid duplicative tools and contracts when the enterprise platform can meet the business need.

- Workforce Adoption

- Focused on improving productivity and operational efficiency.
- Supported by agency-wide training and responsible-use guidance..
- Human review and professional judgment remain essential.

Responsible Governance

- SCAG's governance approach evolves with technology, experience, and business needs.
- Prioritize Data Integrity: Security, Quality, and Accessibility

01

Security & Privacy

Protect sensitive information and use established security/compliance controls where available.

02

Data Governance

Use trusted, accessible, and well-governed data — including enterprise sources such as SharePoint, OneDrive, and Outlook.

03

Transparency & Oversight

Set expectations for responsible use, transparency, human oversight, and professional judgment.

04

Operational Fit

Consider how the solution will be deployed, trained, governed, maintained, and monitored over time.

Targeted Innovation

- Maintain Flexibility for Specialized AI Needs
 - Specialized AI solutions may be required for planning, modeling, forecasting, GIS, and other advanced analytics.
 - Additional procurements are evaluated case-by-case based on business value, security, cost, and user requirements.



Bottom line: Procure specialized AI tool when it delivers a clear capability or value that the enterprise platform cannot provide adequately.

Vermont AOT's Framework for AI Procurement *Before You Buy*

SEPTEMBER 17, 2026

VERMONT AGENCY OF TRANSPORTATION

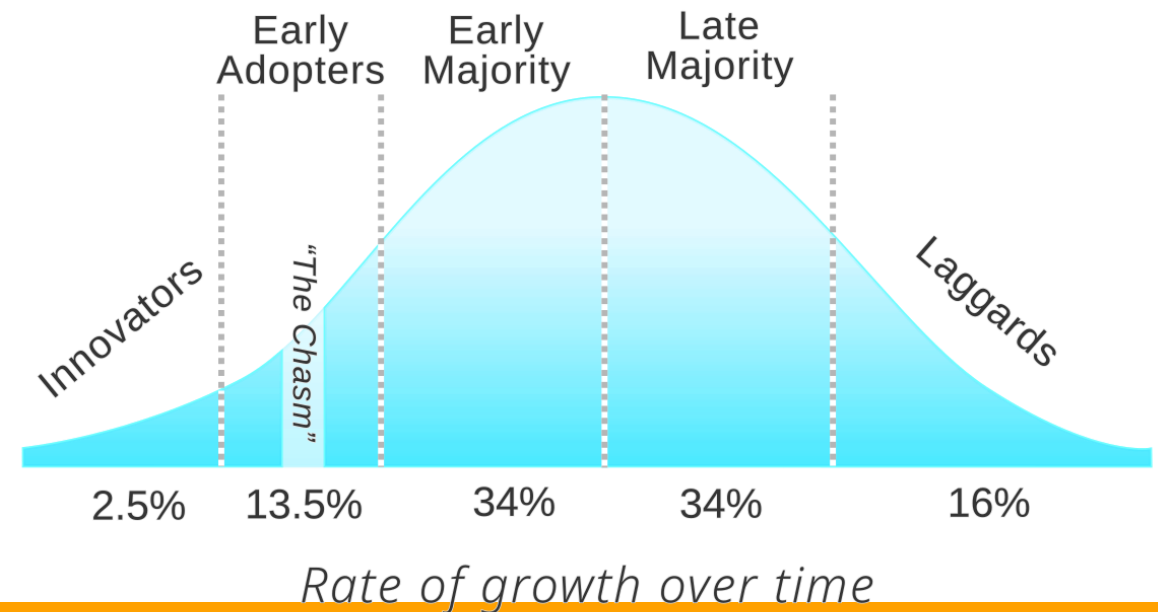
Setting the Foundation

Selecting a Contract Manager

- Technical program contact vs. technology professional
- Hiring decision was a joint process with centralized IT partners
 - Established a foundation of collaboration between agencies
- Suggested skills & competencies:
 - Experience with contracting (ex: COR Level II)
 - Product Ownership and/or Business Analyst

Where do you want to be on the technology Adoption Curve?

Innovation Adoption Curve



Procurement Strategies for Scaling

Pilot Projects

- Establish when procurement is needed – can this be piloted internally with available tools?

Vermont's AI Pilot Procurement Strategy

- Paid Pilot solicited through a Simplified Bid
 - Low-cost, firm fixed price, 1-year contract vehicle
 - Limited solicitation to vendors identified at the discretion of the contract manager
 - Allows for ample time to have large user acceptance testing period across AOT staff and partners
 - Set evaluation framework that will drive the Go/No-Go decision following the end of the period of performance

Award Phase: Panel Members

Facilitator

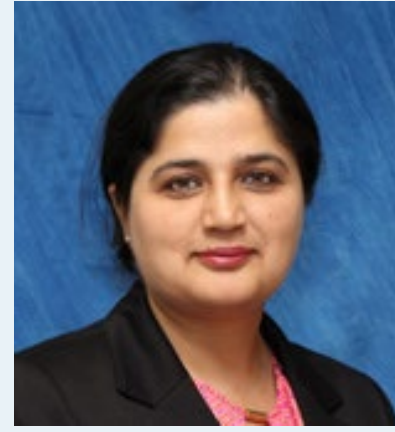


Karl Wunderlich
ITS JPO Consultant

Agency Panelists



**Ploisongsaeng (Ploi)
Intaratip**
*Missouri DOT
Assistant Traffic
Liaison Engineer*



Namita Uppal
*Miami-Dade County
Strategic Procurement
Dept, Director and
Chief Procurement
Officer*

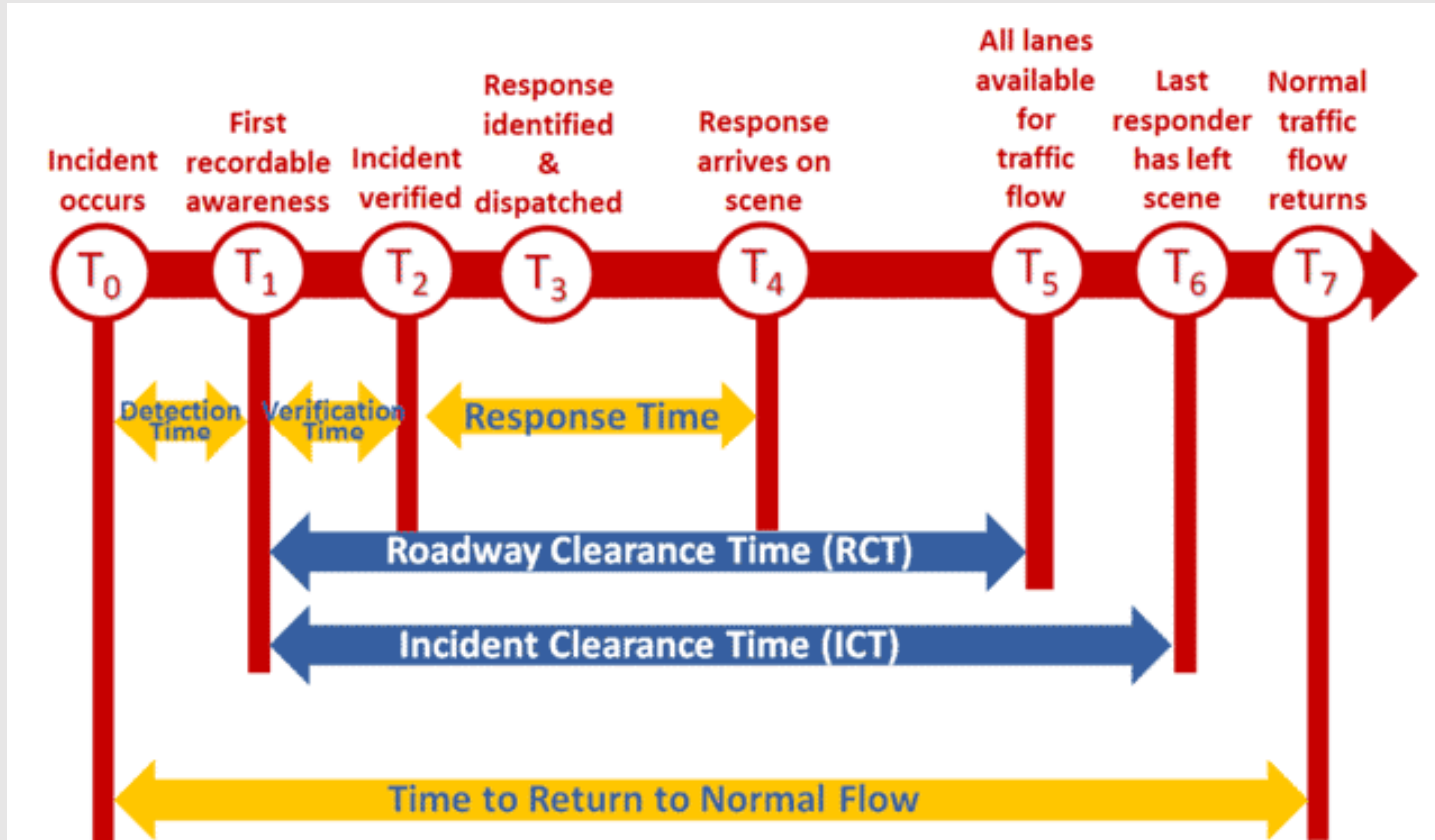


Alicia Winkelblech
*City of Arlington, TX
Director of
Transportation*

I-270 Predictive Layered Operation Initiatives

PLOISONGSAENG INTARATIP, MODOT





Goals

- Reduce T₀ – T₂ time
- Reduce T₃ – T₄ time
- Reduce secondary crashes
- Crash Risk Prediction

Process



Internal MoDOT Departments



Vendors



Project timeline

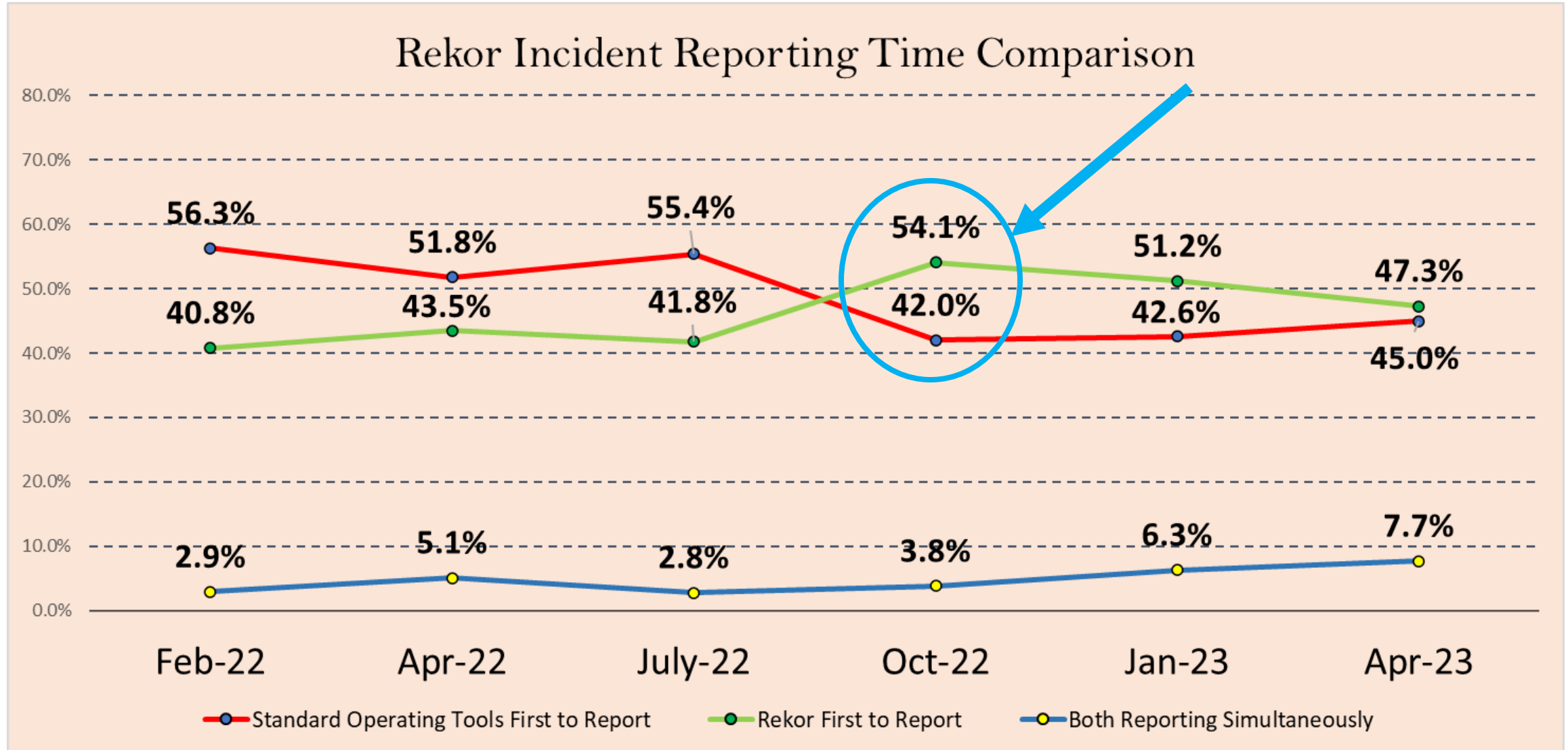
Data

- Probe
- TMC (CCTV, DMS)
- ER log
- Weather (RWIS)
- Interstate detections
- Historical crash
- Connected Vehicle (Wejo, Otonomo, Volvo)
- Weather
- Road condition
- Work zones (Dash Cam)
- 911 CAD



Incident Detection Comparison

Rekor vs. Standard Operating Procedures



Need Action ⁶

In Progress (0)

Completed



Sort by: Newest First



2:56 PM, Feb 28 2023

7965963 | Type unknown

I-70 WB Before 370 (Freeway)

Confirm

Reject



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7965924 | Crash | Minor

I-270 SB Before 255 (Freeway)

Confirm

Reject

👁️ vogelk1



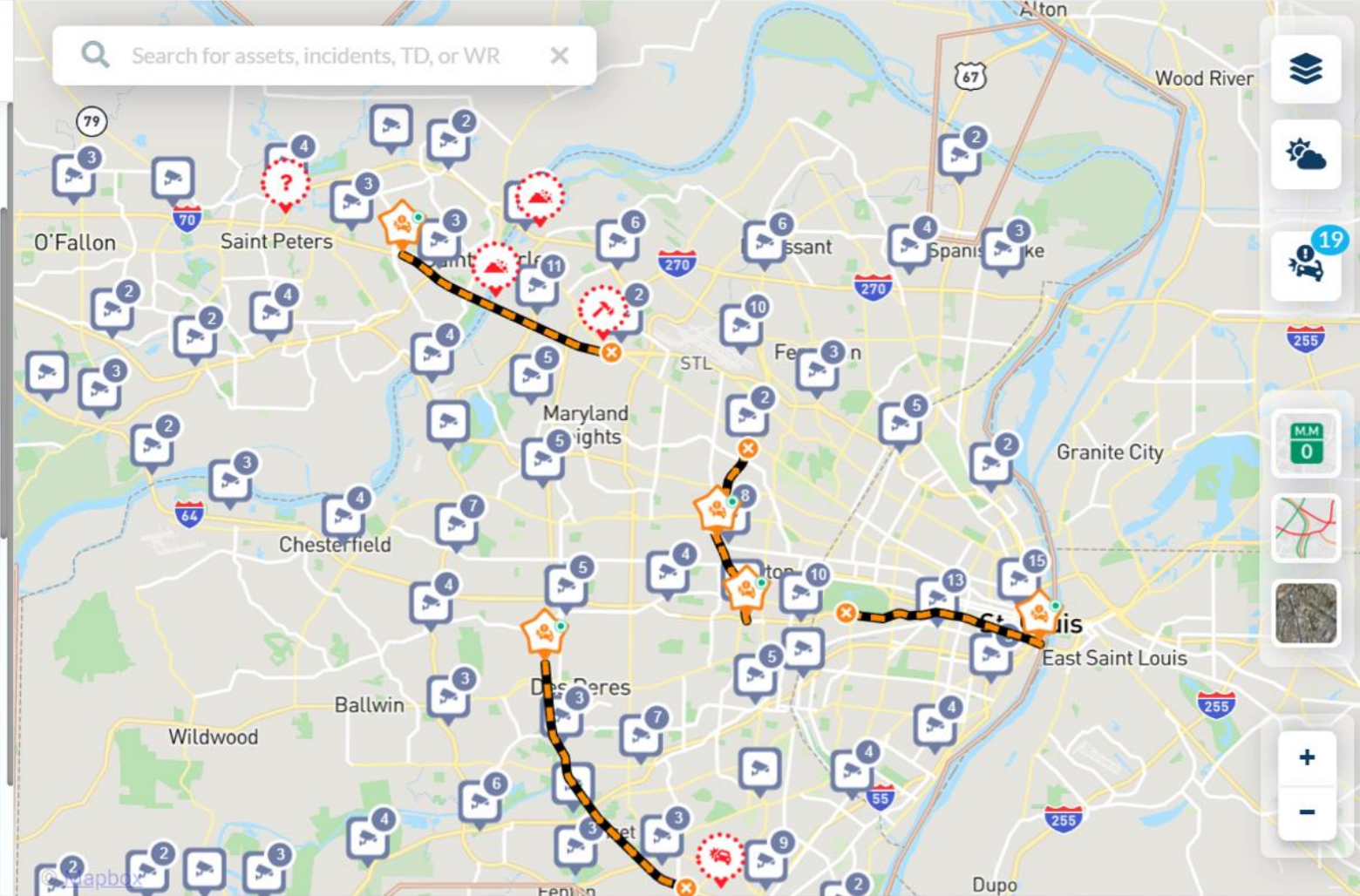
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Confirm

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Thank you

Agency Speakers for Lightning Talks

Facilitator



Haley Townsend
ITS JPO
Consultant

Agency Speakers



John Hibbard
Georgia DOT
*Division Director of
Operations*



Skye Guo
District DOT
ITS Specialist



Christina Karanikolas
***RTC of Southern
Nevada***
Manager of Engineering



Bhaskar Rudrakshala
Caltrans
*Division Chief of
Application
Development & Support*

Georgia DOT Experience

Ideation: What is the use case? What are you trying to accomplish?

- Georgia DOT's TMC-React
 - Use case
 - Unintended consequence
- From the outset, incorporating user needs and perspective
 - You have to talk to people!
- Establishing means to evaluate user experience and need fulfillment

Georgia DOT Experience

Procurement: But I just want to buy it!

- We are 50 states
 - Anything I say is very Georgia-specific
 - With 50 sets of unique and different state law
 - And 50 different Procurement (Purchasing?) offices?
- Get to know your Procurement Department Head
- Pilot contract potential?
 - What are limitations?
- Leveraging consortium contracts, catalog contracts, or similar mechanisms
- Contractual considerations
 - That clearly spell out the boring (but really important) stuff:
 - Duration
 - Where will it be hosted?
 - Whose data does it train on?
 - What happens when development is done

Georgia DOT Experience

Development and Deployment:

- So – remember from a couple of slides ago?
 - Where will it be hosted?
 - Whose data does it train on?
 - What happens when development is done?
- How are those decisions working out?
- Is the tool being used as anticipated?



LET'S GO

FROM PILOT TO SCALE
LESSONS LEARNED DEPLOYING AI

*Christina Karanikolas, P.E., PTOE
Manager of Engineering – RTC FAST*



WE'RE GOING PLACES. LET'S GO TOGETHER

ADVANCED INTERSECTION ANALYTICS QUESTIONS



Is this a viable technology?



Can this provide accurate data that is actionable?



Is this scalable?



ADVANCED INTERSECTION ANALYTICS

RFI PROJECT DESCRIPTION



*Collect Traffic
Data*



*Utilize existing camera feed or
vendor-supplied equipment*



*Apply artificial
intelligence*



*Obtain insight into
intersection safety*

RTC's AI PROJECT BACKGROUND

*RFI to
Industry*

6-month Pilot

*Stage 1
SMART Grant*

*Grant Funding
for Full Scale
Deployment*

LESSONS LEARNED



*Stakeholder
Composition*



*Clearly outline
existing systems*



*IT and Cybersecurity
Requirements*



*Agency Legal Team
Concurrence*



*Anticipate FAST support
for troubleshooting*



Local Vendor Support



Christina Karanikolas, P.E., PTOE

Manager of Engineering
karanikolasc@rtcsonv.com



LET'S GO FROM PILOT TO SCALE | LESSONS LEARNED DEPLOYING AI

AI AT CALTRANS



Demystifying AI Procurement

Governance as Enterprise Strategy

ITS JPO National Webinar

Demystifying AI Procurement: Actionable Strategies for Transportation Agencies

September 17, 2026, 3 to 4 pm Eastern

Presenter: Bhaskar Rudrakshala, Division Chief, Caltrans

Post Award Lightning Talk Session



SETTING THE FRAME

What Is AI Governance at Caltrans

The enterprise framework that ensures AI is adopted responsibly, safely, and in service of the department's mission, rather than as technology for its own sake.



Core philosophy

AI is a mission accelerator; start with the need, not the technology.



People First, human at the helm!

AI drafts, people decide, professionals stay accountable.



How it is structured

A GenAI Governance Subcommittee under the IT Governance Council, with CIO sponsorship.



Built alongside innovation

Grew alongside our earliest AI pilots since the 2023 Executive Order.



HOW GOVERNANCE OPERATES

Eight Strategic Approaches

- ✓ **Clear accountability**
Who leads AI strategy and who decides
- ✓ **Mission alignment**
Every solution serves a transportation outcome
- ✓ **Durable yet adaptable**
Stable at the policy level, flexible in practice
- ✓ **Value based selection**
Readiness, mission value, and risk, not novelty
- ✓ **Integrated controls**
Built into enterprise controls, not run separately
- ✓ **Data and AI interdependence**
Responsible AI needs trusted, well stewarded data
- ✓ **Workforce usability**
Understandable, and backed by training
- ✓ **Lifecycle monitoring**
Outcomes, risk, cost, and value tracked throughout

Key message: *Together, these eight approaches turn governance from a policy document into daily practice.*



PROCUREMENT AND GOVERNANCE

Compliance by Design, Written partly into RFP

AB 2013

Public disclosure of AI systems

EO N 12 23

Enterprise AI governance and oversight

SB 896

GenAI use policies, risk assessments

CPRA

Privacy for systems touching personal data

Written into our TMI and VRU Safety GenAI contracts:

No training on state data

Human at helm

Performance measures

Tested for bias and drift

Audit trail

Data protection

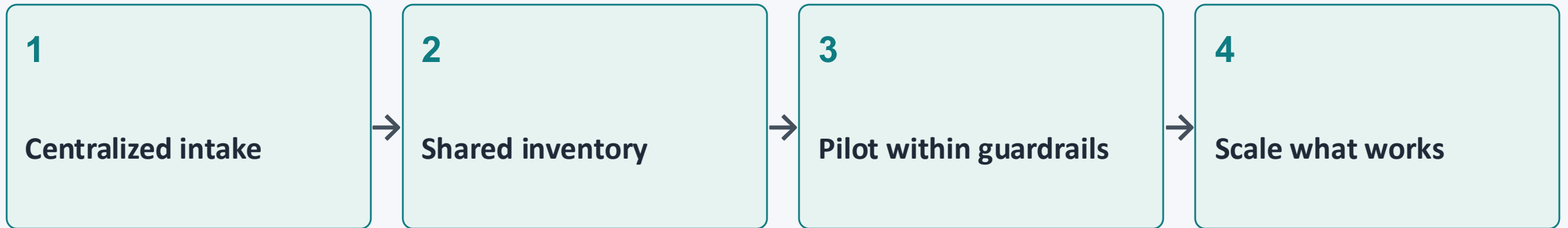
Key message: *AI procurement is a cross functional sport, not an IT only one.*



HOW WE DECIDE

A Five Factor Screen, Centralized Intake

Every opportunity is screened on readiness, mission value, organizational impact, risk, and expected public benefit.



Proven solutions are shared enterprise wide through Communities of Practice, avoiding duplicated purchases.

Key message: *We are buying against a prioritized, vetted need, not a one off request.*



LIFECYCLE GOVERNANCE

From Idea to Retirement

Idea

Design

Test

Deploy

Monitor

Improve

Retire or
Replace



Human oversight stays central

People remain accountable, AI supports judgment.



A trusted data foundation

AI governance and data governance are linked.



Continuous measurement

Performance, risk, cost, value tracked throughout.

Key message: *This lifecycle view is what justifies the exit strategy and monitoring clauses we insist on up front.*



IMPACT AND VALUE

Two Systems Live in Production Today

Traffic Mobility Insights

Accelerates corridor analysis and proactive traffic management.

Road Safety Insights

Supports proactive safety planning and faster response.

What this made possible:

Faster, data driven decisions

Earlier warning of risk and congestion

Quicker emergency and safety response

Better information, sooner

Key message: *The real measure is not policies written or meetings held. It is safer, more accessible transportation for the public.*



THE PLAYBOOK

Four Steps Any Agency Can Run

1 Cross functional intake

Business, data, privacy, security, legal, procurement, and IT in one room.

2 Design the solicitation deliberately

Require data disclosure; mandate oversight, measures, and exit terms.

3 Evaluate and pilot

Score mission fit, risk, and ethics alongside cost, with pilot gates.

4 Oversee and retire

Track value on dashboards; define end of life from the start.

Key message: *Run those four steps and governance stops being paperwork and starts being leverage.*



CALL TO ACTION

From Governance Foundation to Enterprise Practice

1

Adopt governance first procurement

Make safe, mission driven AI the default.

2

Enable your workforce

Training and a champions network build practice.

3

Share and scale

Exchange RFP language and lessons with peers.

“Our objective at Caltrans has never been simply to adopt more AI. It is to adopt the right AI, for the right reasons, with the right safeguards, and clear accountability for results.”

Our commitments stay constant: trusted data, governance, oversight, workforce enablement, transparency, and public value.



Questions and Discussion

Bhaskar Rudrakshala, Caltrans

AI AT CALTRANS